```
        "format": "dd-MM-yyyy||dd-MM-yy"
      }
    }
  }
}
```

Date is set in either of these two formats.

Incoming documents can now have the departure field set as

```
"departure_date_time" :"06-08-2021"
```

or

```
"departure_date_time" :"06-08-21"
```

In addition to providing the date as a string value, we can provide it in a number format—either seconds or milliseconds since the epoch (January 1, 1970). The following mapping definition sets three dates with three different formats:

```
{
  ...
  "properties": {
    "string_date":{ "type": "date", "format": "dd-MM-yyyy" },
    "millis_date":{ "type": "date", "format": "epoch_millis" },
    "seconds_date":{ "type": "date", "format": "epoch_second"}
  }
}
```

The given dates are converted internally to `long` values stored in milliseconds since the epoch, equivalent to `epoch_millis`.

We can use `range` queries to fetch dates. For example, the following snippet retrieves flights scheduled between 5:00 and 5:30 a.m. on a given date:

```
"range": {
  "departure_date_time": {
    "gte": "2021-08-06T05:00:00",
    "lte": "2021-08-06T05:30:00"
    }
}
```

A range query fetching documents between two dates

The time range is between 5:00 and 5.30 a.m.

Finally, we can accept multiple date formats on a single field by declaring the required formats:

```
"departure_date_time":{
  "type": "date",
  "format": "dd-MM-yyyy||dd/MM/yyyy||yyyy-MM-dd||yyyy/MM/dd"
}
```

Sets four different formats on the field

Refer to the documentation about Elasticsearch's `date` data type for more information, as we can't cover all the options in this chapter. Also refer to the book's files for complete examples.